“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 17

Śrī Caitanya Goes to Vṛndāvana

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 As Gaura went to Vṛndāvana, He made the tigers, elephants, deer and birds of the forest mad with love: they danced along with Him and chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

3 When autumn came, the Lord resolved to set out, and He took counsel in private with Rāmānanda and Svarūpa.

4 “If you two will help Me, I may go and see Śrī Vṛndāvana.

5 I shall rise at night and slip away by the forest path. I shall go alone and take no one with Me.

6 If anyone gets up and runs after Me to keep Me company, hold them all back, so that no one follows.

7 Give Me leave gladly, and do not take it as a sorrow. If you are all happy, I shall be happy on the road.”

8 The two of them said, “You are the independent Lord. Whatever You wish, You will do; You depend on no one.

9 But hear one request from the two of us. You Yourself have said, ‘In your happiness is My happiness.’

10 Our hearts will be very happy, O merciful Lord, if You grant us one request.

11 We certainly want one good brāhmaṇa to go with You. He will collect alms and give You Your meals, and he will carry Your waterpot.

12 On the forest path there is no brāhmaṇa whose food You could accept. Permit one brāhmaṇa to go with You.”

13 The Lord said, “I shall not take any of My own companions. If I take one, the others will be unhappy.

14 Let My companion be someone new, whose heart is full of love. If I find such a person, I will take one.”

15 Svarūpa said, “Here is Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya. He is full of love for You, and he is learned, saintly and noble.

16 He came with You from Gauḍa at the very start, and he wishes to visit all the holy places.

17 With him is a brāhmaṇa servant, and on the road the Bhaṭṭācārya himself will serve You and see to Your meals.

18 If You take him with You, everyone will be happy, and You will meet no hardship on the forest path.

19 That brāhmaṇa will carry Your cloth and waterpot, and the Bhaṭṭācārya will go begging alms and give You Your meals.”

20 The Lord accepted Svarūpa's words and took Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya with Him.

21 The night before, He went to see Jagannātha and took His leave. Then, rising at the end of the night, the Lord set out in secret.

22 In the morning the devotees could not find the Lord, and they went about searching for Him in distress.

23 Svarūpa Gosāñi held them all back, and knowing the Lord's mind, they all gave up the search.

24 Leaving the main road, the Lord went by a side path. Keeping Kaṭaka on His right, He entered the forest.

25 The Lord went through the lonely forest chanting Kṛṣṇa's name, and elephants and tigers left the path when they saw Him.

26 There were herds of tigers, elephants, rhinoceroses and boars, and the Lord, absorbed in ecstasy, made His way through their midst.

27 Seeing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya was terrified, but by the Lord's power the animals stood aside.

28 One day a tiger was lying on the path, and the Lord, absorbed in ecstasy, touched its body with His foot.

29 The Lord said, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!" The tiger rose and began to dance, saying, "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!"

30 On another day, while Mahāprabhu was bathing in a river, a herd of maddened elephants came to drink.

31 While the Lord was performing His rites in the water, the elephants came before Him. Saying, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’!” the Lord splashed water at them.

32 Whoever was touched by a spray of those drops cried, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” and danced and sang in love.

33 Some fell to the ground, and some trumpeted loudly. Seeing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya was struck with wonder.

34 As He went along the road, the Lord would sing the Name aloud, and hearing His sweet voice, the does came to Him.

35 Listening to the sound, they walked with the Lord on His right and left. The Lord stroked them and joyfully recited a verse:

36 “Blessed are these does! Though foolish by nature, when they heard the flute they came with their black bucks to the son of Nanda, in His colourful dress, and worshipped Him with loving glances.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.21.11)

37 Just then five or seven tigers came there, and tigers and does walked together with Mahāprabhu.

38 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu remembered Vṛndāvana, and He recited a verse describing its glories:

39 “There, in the abode of the Unconquered Lord, men and beasts, enemies by nature, lived together like friends, and anger, thirst and the like had fled away.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.13.60)

40 When the Lord said, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!’” the tigers and deer began to dance, saying, “Kṛṣṇa!”

41 The tigers danced and wept together with the does, and Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya watched this unprecedented sport.

42 The tigers and deer embraced one another, and putting mouth to mouth, they kissed.

43 Seeing this delightful scene, the Lord began to laugh. Then He left them all there and went on ahead.

44 Seeing the Lord, peacocks and other birds went along with Him, crying "Kṛṣṇa" and dancing as if mad.

45 The Lord called aloud, "Hari bol!" and the trees and creepers rejoiced to hear it.

46 All the moving and nonmoving beings of Jhārikhaṇḍa He made mad with love by giving them Kṛṣṇa's name.

47 In every village He passed through or stayed in, the people gained loving devotion, *prema-bhakti*.

48–49 If anyone heard Kṛṣṇa's name from His mouth, another heard it from that person's mouth, and yet another from his. Saying "Kṛṣṇa!" and "Hari!", they all danced, wept and laughed, and so, one from another, people became Vaiṣṇavas in every land.

50 Although the Lord, wary of crowds, kept His love hidden and did not show it outwardly,

51 still, by the power of seeing and hearing Him, the people of every land became Vaiṣṇavas.

52 Going to Gauḍa, Vaṅga, Utkala and the South, He delivered the people, wandering there Himself.

53 On the pretext of going to Mathurā He came to Jhārikhaṇḍa, where the people lived almost outside the Vedic order and were great unbelievers.

54 Giving them the Name and love, He delivered them all. Who has the power to understand the hidden pastimes of Caitanya?

55 Seeing a forest, He would take it for Vṛndāvana; seeing a hill, He would think it Govardhana.

56 Wherever He saw a river, He took it for the Kālindī. Overwhelmed by love, the Lord danced and fell down weeping.

57 As they went along the road, the Bhaṭṭācārya gathered whatever greens, roots and fruits he could find.

58 In whatever village the Lord stayed, five or seven brāhmaṇas would come and invite Him.

59 Some brought grain and left it with the Bhaṭṭācārya; some brought milk and yogurt, and some ghee and sugar.

60 Where there were no brāhmaṇas, respectable men of the *śūdra* community came and invited the Bhaṭṭācārya.

61 The Bhaṭṭācārya cooked vegetables from the forest, and the Lord was delighted with them.

62–63 He kept grain for two or four days with him. Where the forest was empty and no one lived, the Bhaṭṭācārya cooked that grain and made dishes from fruits, roots and many kinds of forest greens.

64 The Lord was perfectly content with the forest fare, and He was happiest on the days He spent in solitude.

65 The Bhaṭṭācārya served Him lovingly, like a servant, and his brāhmaṇa carried the waterpot and the outer cloth.

66 He bathed three times a day in the warm water of springs, and at dawn and dusk He sat by a fire, for there was no end of firewood.

67 Travelling in solitude, He was constantly absorbed in love. Feeling this happiness, the Lord said:

68 "Listen, Bhaṭṭācārya. I have travelled through many lands, but on this forest path I find not a trace of hardship anywhere.

69 Kṛṣṇa is merciful. He has shown Me great mercy: bringing Me by the forest path, He has given Me great happiness.

70 Earlier, when I set out for Vṛndāvana, I thought, 'I shall see My mother, the Gaṅgā and the devotees once more.

71 I shall surely meet the devotees, and I shall take them with Me to Vṛndāvana.'

72 With this in mind I went to Gauḍa, and My heart was happy to see My mother, the Gaṅgā and the devotees.

73 Then I joyfully set out with the devotees, and hundreds of thousands of people there joined Me.

74 Kṛṣṇa taught Me through Sanātana's mouth. He put an end to that journey and brought Me by the forest path.

75 He is an ocean of mercy, compassionate to the poor and the fallen. Without Kṛṣṇa's mercy there is no happiness at all."

76 Embracing the Bhaṭṭācārya, He said to him, "By your kindness I have found so much happiness."

77 He replied, "You are Kṛṣṇa! You are merciful! I am a fallen soul, yet You have been kind to me.

78 I am worthless, yet You have brought me with You. In Your mercy, my Lord, You have taken Your meals from my hand.

79 You have made a lowly crow equal to Garuḍa. You are the independent Lord, *Svayam Bhagavān* Himself."

80 "I bow down to Mādhava, the supreme bliss, whose mercy makes the mute eloquent and makes the lame cross mountains."[2] (Śrīdhara Svāmī, Bhāvārtha-dīpikā on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.1)

81 In this way Balabhadra offered praise, and by his loving service he pleased the Lord.

82 So the Lord came joyfully to Kāśī, and there He took His midday bath at Maṇikarṇikā.

83 At that time Tapana Miśra was bathing in the Gaṅgā. When he saw the Lord, he was struck with wonder.

84 "I heard earlier that the Lord had taken *sannyāsa*," he thought, and when he was sure it was He, his heart filled with joy.

85 Clasping the Lord's feet, he wept, and the Lord raised him up and embraced him.

86 He took the Lord to see Viśveśvara, and then they came and saw the feet of Bindu-mādhava.

87 Full of joy, he brought the Lord home, served Him, and danced, waving his cloth.

88 With all his family he drank the water that had washed the Lord's feet, and he honoured the Bhaṭṭācārya with worship.

89 He invited the Lord and fed Him in his home, having Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya do the cooking.

90 After His meal Mahāprabhu lay down to rest, and Miśra's son Raghu massaged His feet.

91 Miśra and all his family ate the Lord's remnants. Hearing that the Lord had come, Candraśekhara came too.

92 He was Miśra's friend and an old servant of the Lord. A *vaidya* by caste and a scribe by profession, he lived in Vārāṇasī.

93 He came, fell at the Lord's feet and wept, and the Lord rose and mercifully embraced him.

94 Candraśekhara said, "Lord, You have shown me great mercy: You came Yourself to give Your servant Your darśana.

95 By my own *prārabdha*, the karma now bearing fruit, I live in Vārāṇasī, and my ears hear nothing but the words '*māyā*' and 'Brahman.'

96 Here there is no talk but explanations of the six philosophies. Only Miśra, in his kindness, lets me hear about Kṛṣṇa.

97 We two constantly meditate on Your feet, and You, the omniscient Lord, have given us Your darśana.

98 I hear that Mahāprabhu is going to Śrī Vṛndāvana. Stay a few days and deliver Your two servants.”

99 Miśra said, “Lord, as long as You stay in Kāśī, please accept no invitation but mine.”

100 So Mahāprabhu, yielding to His two servants, stayed there ten days, though He had no wish to.

101 A brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra would come to see the Lord, and he was amazed to see the Lord’s beauty and love.

102 All the brāhmaṇas invited Him, but the Lord would not accept. “Today I already have an invitation,” He would say.

103 In this way He evaded them every day. Wary of the company of the *sannyāsīs*, He accepted no invitations.

104 Prakāśānanda Śrīpāda sat in his assembly and taught Vedānta to his many disciples.

105 One brāhmaṇa who had seen the Lord’s conduct came and told Prakāśānanda about Him.

106 “A *sannyāsī* has come from Jagannātha Purī. I cannot describe His glory and power.

107 Everything I see in Him is wonderful to tell: His body is tall and powerful, and His complexion is like pure gold.

108 His arms reach to His knees, His eyes are like lotuses, and He bears every auspicious mark of the Lord.

109 Seeing these marks, one understands, ‘This is Nārāyaṇa.’ Whoever sees Him begins to chant the names of Kṛṣṇa.

110 I hear in the *Bhāgavata* the marks of a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a great devotee, and I see all those marks plainly in Him.

111 His tongue sings Kṛṣṇa’s name unceasingly, and tears flow from His eyes like the streams of the Gaṅgā.

112 At times He dances, laughs, sings and weeps; at times He roars like a lion.

113 His name, ‘Kṛṣṇa Caitanya,’ brings good to the whole world. His name, form and qualities are all beyond compare.

114 When you see Him, you know that His ways are the ways of the Lord. But who would believe such an extraordinary account just by hearing it?”

115 Hearing this, Prakāśānanda laughed heartily, and mocking the brāhmaṇa, he said,

116 “I have heard of Him — the sentimental *sannyāsī* from Gauḍa, a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī and a deceiver of people.

117 His name is Caitanya. He goes about with His sentimentalists from land to land and village to village, making them dance.

118 “Whoever sees Him declares Him to be God. Such is His art of enchantment: whoever looks at Him falls under its spell.

119 “Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya is a formidable scholar, yet I hear that in Caitanya’s company he has gone mad.

120 “He is a sannyāsī in name only; in fact He is a great conjurer. But here in Kāśī His wares of emotion will not sell.

121 “Keep hearing Vedānta and do not go near Him. The company of unruly people ruins both this world and the next.”

122 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa was deeply pained. Saying “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” he rose and left that place.

123 His mind had been purified by seeing the Lord. Sorrowfully he came before the Lord and told Him everything.

124 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled slightly, and the brāhmaṇa asked the Lord again:

125 “When I spoke Your name before him, he himself said that he knew Your name.

126 “While speaking of Your faults he uttered Your name, saying ‘Caitanya, Caitanya’ three times.

127 “But in all three times the name of Kṛṣṇa never came to his lips. He takes Your name with contempt, and hearing it pains me.

128 “Please be kind and tell me the reason for this. When I see You, my mouth says ‘Kṛṣṇa!’ and ‘Hari!’ ”

129 The Lord said, “The Māyāvādīs are offenders against Kṛṣṇa. They incessantly say ‘Brahman,’ ‘ātmā,’ ‘caitanya’ (consciousness).

130 “Therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa does not come to their lips. The name of Kṛṣṇa and Kṛṣṇa’s own form are one and the same.

131 “The name, the form (*vigraha*) and the essential nature (*svarūpa*) are one. There is no difference among the three: all three are forms of consciousness and bliss.

132 “In Kṛṣṇa there is no difference between the body and its possessor, or between the name and the one named. It is the jīva’s nature that his name, body and true self are different.

133 “The name is a wish-fulfilling gem; it is Kṛṣṇa Himself, the embodiment of consciousness and rasa — complete, pure and eternally liberated, for the name and the named are not different.” (Padma Purāṇa)

134 “Therefore Kṛṣṇa’s name, His body and His pastimes cannot be grasped by the material senses; they manifest themselves.

135 “Kṛṣṇa’s name, His qualities and all His pastimes are equal to Kṛṣṇa’s own form: all of them are consciousness and bliss.

136 “Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s name, form, qualities and pastimes cannot be grasped by the material senses. When one is turned toward service, they reveal themselves of their own accord, beginning on the tongue.” (Padma Purāṇa; cited in Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.234)

137 “The rasa of His pastimes is fuller bliss than the bliss of Brahman. It attracts even the knower of Brahman and makes him its own.

138 “His mind was absorbed in the happiness of the self, and so he had cast off every other feeling; yet his heart was drawn by the charming pastimes of the Unconquered Lord, and out of mercy he composed the Purāṇa about

Him, the lamp of the truth. To him, the son of Vyāsa, the destroyer of all sins, I bow down." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 12.12.69)

139 "Kṛṣṇa's qualities are fuller bliss than the bliss of Brahman. Therefore they attract the mind even of one who delights in the self.

140 "Even sages who delight in the ātmā and are free from the knots of the heart render causeless devotion to Urukrama, for such are the qualities of Hari." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.10)

141 "Let all this be. The fragrance of tulasī that has touched Kṛṣṇa's feet steals the mind of one who delights in the self.

142 "The breeze, carrying the fragrance of the tulasī mixed with the filaments of the lotus feet of the lotus-eyed Lord, entered within them through their nostrils and stirred both mind and body, though they were devoted to the imperishable Brahman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.15.43)

143 "Therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa does not come to the lips of the Māyāvādīs, for they are utterly averse to the Lord.

144 "I came to Kāśī to sell My wares of emotion, but there is no buyer; they do not sell, so I shall have to take them back home.

145 "I came with a heavy load — how can I carry it back? If I get even a small price, I will sell it right here."

146 Saying this, Gaurahari made that brāhmaṇa His own, and rising early the next morning He set out for Mathurā.

147 Those three followed Him, but the Lord forbade them, and from some way along the road He sent all three back home.

148 In separation from the Lord the three would meet together and sing of His qualities, maddened with love.

149 Coming to Prayāga, the Lord bathed in the river, and on seeing Mādhava He danced and sang in love.

150 Seeing the Yamunā, He leapt into it in love, and the Bhaṭṭācārya hurriedly caught hold of Him and lifted Him out.

151 In this way He stayed three days in Prayāga, delivering the people by giving them the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him.

152 Wherever He stopped on the way to Mathurā, He gave the people the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him and made them dance.

153 As He had delivered the people before when He went to the south, so in the western lands He made everyone a Vaiṣṇava.

154 Wherever He caught sight of the Yamunā along the way, He leapt into it and fell unconscious in love.

155 When He drew near Mathurā and saw the city, He fell down flat like a rod, overwhelmed with love.

156 Arriving in Mathurā, He bathed at Viśrāma-tīrtha, and at the birthplace He saw Keśava and bowed down to Him.

157 Rapt in love, He danced, sang and roared again and again, and the people were astonished to see the Lord’s rapture of love.

158 A brāhmaṇa fell down and clasped the Lord’s feet, and then, overwhelmed with love, he danced with the Lord.

159 Dancing in love, the two embraced each other, and with arms raised they both called out, “Hari! Kṛṣṇa!”

160 The people cried, “Hari! Hari!” and a great tumult arose. Keśava’s servant placed a garland on the Lord.

161 Seeing the Lord, the people were amazed and said, “Love such as this is never of this world.

162 “At the sight of Him people become mad with love: they laugh, weep, dance and sing, chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa.

163 “It is certain in every way that He is an avatāra of Kṛṣṇa. He has come to Mathurā to deliver the people.”

164 Then Mahāprabhu took that brāhmaṇa aside, sat with him in private and asked him:

165 “You are noble and simple-hearted, an aged brāhmaṇa. Where did you get this treasure of love?”

166 The brāhmaṇa said, “Śrīpāda Mādhavendra Purī came to the city of Mathurā in the course of his wanderings.

167 “Out of kindness he came to my home. He made me his disciple and accepted his meal (*bhikṣā*) from my hands.

168 “That great soul brought Gopāla to light and served Him, and to this day Gopāla is served at Govardhana.”

169 Hearing this, the Lord bowed down at the brāhmaṇa’s feet, and the brāhmaṇa in fear fell at the Lord’s feet.

170 The Lord said, “You are in the position of a guru, and I am like your disciple. It is not proper for a guru to bow down to a disciple.”

171 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa was astonished and said in fear, “You are a sannyāsī — why do You speak like this?

172 “But seeing Your love, I infer that You have some connection with Mādhavendra Purī; I am sure of it.

173 “Love for Kṛṣṇa is found where there is a connection with him. Without him there is not even a scent of such love anywhere.”

174 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya told him of the connection, and hearing it the brāhmaṇa began to dance with joy.

175 Then the brāhmaṇa took the Lord to his own home and of his own accord rendered Him many kinds of service.

176 He had the Bhaṭṭācārya cook for the Lord’s meal, but Mahāprabhu smiled and said:

177 “Purī Gosāñi has taken his meals in your house. You yourself give Me My meal — this is My instruction.

178 “Whatever the best of men does, others do the same; whatever standard he sets, the world follows.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.21)

179 That brāhmaṇa was a Sanoḍiyā, and sannyāsīs do not eat in a Sanoḍiyā’s house.

180 Nevertheless, seeing his Vaiṣṇava conduct, Purī made him his disciple and accepted meals from him.

181 When Mahāprabhu asked him for a meal, the brāhmaṇa humbly began to say:

182 “To give You a meal is my great good fortune. You are the Lord; You are not bound by rules of conduct.

183 “But foolish people will censure You, and I will not be able to bear the words of those wicked people.”

184 The Lord said, “The śruti, the smṛti and all the sages are not of one opinion; they teach many different kinds of dharma.

185 “The conduct of a sādhu is what establishes dharma, and the conduct of Purī Gosāñi is the essence of dharma.

186 “Argument is inconclusive, the śrutis differ from one another, and there is no sage whose opinion does not differ from the others. The truth of dharma is hidden in a cave; the path is the one by which the great souls have gone.” (Mahābhārata, Vana-parva 313.117)

187 Then the brāhmaṇa served the Lord His meal, and all the people of Madhupurī (Mathurā) came to see the Lord.

188 People came by the hundreds of thousands, beyond counting, and the Lord came out of the house and showed Himself to them.

189 Raising His arms, the Lord called out, “Haribol!” and the people danced, mad with love, calling out the name of Hari.

190 The Lord bathed at the twenty-four ghāṭs of the Yamunā, and the brāhmaṇa showed Him the holy places.

191 He saw Svayambhu, Viśrāma, Dīrgha-viṣṇu, Bhūteśvara, Mahāvidyā, Gokarṇa and many other places.

192 When the Lord wished to see the forests, He took that same brāhmaṇa with Him.

193 He went to Madhuvana, Tālavana, Kumudavana and Bahulāvana, bathing in each place and becoming overwhelmed with love.

194 On the way, a herd of grazing cows saw the Lord, came up lowing loudly and surrounded Him.

195 At the sight of the cows the Lord stood stunned in waves of love, and with motherly affection the cows licked His whole body.

196 Coming to Himself, the Lord scratched the cows' bodies, and they walked along with Him and would not leave Him.

197 With great difficulty the cowherd held all the cows back. Then herds of does, hearing the sound of the Lord's voice, came to Him.

198 Looking at His face, the bucks and does licked the Lord's body. Without any fear they followed Him along the paths.

199 Seeing the Lord, the parrots, cuckoos and bees sang in the fifth note (*pañcama*), and the peacocks went dancing before Him.

200 Seeing the Lord, the trees and creepers of Vṛndāvana put forth sprouts like hair standing on end in ecstasy, and they rained honey like tears.

201 Their branches, laden with flowers and fruits, bent down to the Lord's feet, as a friend comes with a gift on seeing a friend.

202 Seeing the Lord, all the moving and unmoving beings of Vṛndāvana rejoiced, as a friend rejoices on seeing his friends.

203 Seeing the love of all of them, the Lord, rapt in ecstasy, played with them all, as if He were in their power.

204 The Lord embraced every tree and creeper, and in meditation He offered their flowers and other gifts to Kṛṣṇa.

205 His body was restless with the tears, trembling and thrills of love, and He called out in a loud voice, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'! Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!"

206 All the moving and unmoving beings together cried out "Kṛṣṇa!", as if echoing the Lord's deep voice.

207 Embracing a deer around the neck, the Lord wept, and the deer's body thrilled, and tears filled its eyes.

208 On the branch of a tree a male and a female parrot appeared, and seeing them, the Lord wished to hear them say something.

209 The parrots flew down onto the Lord's hand, and for the Lord to hear they began reciting verses about Kṛṣṇa's qualities.

210 (The male parrot recited:) "His beauty shatters the composure of the young women; His pastimes astonish Ramā (Lakṣmī); His strength turns the best of mountains into a ball; His spotless qualities are beyond all counting; His character delights all people. Aho! May our Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enchanter of the world, whose fame is a blessing for the whole world, protect the universe." (Govinda-līlāmṛta 13.29)

211 Having heard the description of Kṛṣṇa from the mouth of the male parrot, the female parrot then recited a description of Rādhikā:

212 “Śrī Rādhikā’s affection, the beauty of Her own form, Her good character, Her skill in dancing and singing, Her wealth of qualities and Her poetry shine forth; they enchant the heart of Him who enchants the minds of the whole world.” (Govinda-līlāmṛta 13.30)

213 Again the male parrot said, “Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana, the enchanter of Cupid,” and recited another verse:

214 “O śārī, He who holds the flute and steals the hearts of the women of the world, who sports with the cowherd women — may that Madana-mohana be victorious!” (Govinda-līlāmṛta 13.31)

215 Then the female parrot spoke to the male parrot in jest, and hearing her, the Lord was filled with wonder and the joy of love:

216 “When He shines with Rādhā, then He is ‘Madana-mohana,’ the enchanter of Cupid. Otherwise, though He enchants the universe, He Himself is ‘madana-mohita,’ enchanted by Cupid.” (Govinda-līlāmṛta 13.32)

217 The parrots flew back up to the branch of the tree, and the Lord eagerly watched the dancing of the peacocks.

218 Seeing the necks of the peacocks, the Lord remembered the luster of Kṛṣṇa’s body, and Mahāprabhu fell to the ground in the rapture of love.

219 Seeing the Lord unconscious, the brāhmaṇa and the Bhaṭṭācārya tended Him to revive Him.

220 Hurriedly they took Mahāprabhu’s outer cloth, sprinkled His body with water and fanned Him with the cloth.

221 They spoke the name of Kṛṣṇa loudly in the Lord's ear, and regaining consciousness, the Lord rolled about on the ground.

222 In that forest, impassable with thorns, His body was scratched and cut. The Bhaṭṭācārya took the Lord on his lap and calmed Him.

223 Absorbed in Kṛṣṇa, the Lord's mind was overwhelmed with love. Crying "Say it! Say it!" He got up and began to dance.

224 The Bhaṭṭācārya and the brāhmaṇa sang the name of Kṛṣṇa, and the Lord went on along the path, dancing all the way.

225 The brāhmaṇa was amazed to see the Lord's rapture of love, and he grew anxious about how to keep the Lord safe.

226 The absorption in love His mind had known in Nīlācala became a hundred times greater on the way to Vṛndāvana.

227 At the sight of Mathurā His love increased a thousandfold, and when He wandered in the forests it increased a hundred-thousandfold.

228–229 In other lands His love would overflow at the very name of Vṛndāvana, and now He was wandering in Vṛndāvana itself. His mind was overwhelmed with love night and day; He bathed, ate and did everything else only out of habit.

230 Such was His love all the while He wandered through the twelve forests. I have described it in one place; it cannot be described everywhere.

231 Ananta writes in millions of books about all the transformations of love the Lord showed in Vṛndāvana.

232 Yet even He cannot describe a particle of them. To give some indication, I only point the way.

233 The world was flooded by the ocean of Caitanya's pastimes; everyone swims in that ocean as far as his strength allows.

234 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
2. *Paramānanda-mādhava*, "Mādhava, the supreme bliss." According to the *Anubhāṣya*, the words name both Śrī Paramānanda Svāmī of the Viṣṇusvāmī line and Bhagavān Himself, the worshipful Lord of Śrīdhara Svāmī. ↩